

Richard Edwards

DesignOps Manager | Senior UX Designer **Location:** Colchester, CO4 0JY, UK **Phone:** +44 7468 930246 | **Email:** richard.visualdesign@gmail.com **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/richardedwardssa/ | **Portfolio:** visualdesigns.vercel.app/

Professional Summary

Senior UX Designer and DesignOps leader with 20+ years driving UX design excellence, building scalable design systems, and establishing operational frameworks for enterprise software. Proven track record scaling design operations for 70+ designers across 20+ product divisions, reducing onboarding time by 60% and design-to-development cycles by 35%. Expert in design governance, cross-functional stakeholder management, design thinking, and digital transformation initiatives that deliver measurable business impact.

Core Competencies

- **Operations:** Design Operations & Governance, Workflow Optimisation, AI Integration.
- **Design Systems:** Enterprise Design Systems (21+ product divisions), Component Libraries, Design Tokens.
- **Leadership:** Team Leadership & Scaling (70+ designers), Stakeholder Engagement, Mentoring.
- **UX Disciplines:** User Research, Usability Testing, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Prototyping.
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 Compliance, Inclusive Design, Accessibility Testing.

Professional Experience

The Access Group | Remote, UK **DesignOps Manager** | March 2022 – November 2024

- Built and scaled design operations function supporting 70+ designers across product, UX, and brand disciplines.
- Implemented group-wide design system for 21+ software companies, reducing design-to-development time by 35%.
- Managed enterprise UX tool stack including Figma, UserZoom, and Marvin, overseeing vendor negotiations and budget approvals.
- Optimised software licensing and seat allocation, ensuring cost-effective resource utilisation and compliance.
- Standardised workflows, tooling, and governance frameworks across teams, improving design quality and consistency.
- Created onboarding and hiring frameworks, cutting new designer ramp-up time from 6 weeks to 2 weeks (60% reduction).
- Integrated AI-powered workflow tools to enhance team productivity and design iteration speed.

The Access Group | Remote, UK **Senior UX Designer** | April 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered product design improvements that enhanced usability and user engagement across core software platforms.
- Established UI/UX design standards, improving consistency across multiple software brands.
- Led usability testing and research initiatives to drive evidence-based design improvements.
- Conducted user research, stakeholder interviews, and competitive analysis to inform design decisions.

OnePlanet.com | Remote, UK **UX Designer** | December 2018 – April 2021

- Designed and delivered complete user experience for sustainability-focused digital platform from concept to launch.
- Created design system foundations including component libraries, design tokens, and documentation.
- Developed responsive UI and mobile app interfaces for iOS and Android platforms.

Sanlam | Cape Town, South Africa **Visual Architect UI/UX** | November 2002 – March 2017

- Led visual alignment and UX consistency across enterprise web applications for financial services organisation.

- Defined UI standards, accessibility frameworks, and usability testing programmes for multiple product teams.
- Mentored junior designers and provided design direction to development teams.

Technical Skills & Tools

- **Design Tools:** Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, XD), InVision, Miro, UserZoom, Marvin, Axure.
- **Technical:** HTML/CSS (basic understanding), Design APIs, Responsive Design, AI Workflow Integration, Version Control (Git/Abstract).
- **Process:** Agile/Scrum Methodologies, Design Thinking, Change Management, Cross-functional Collaboration.

Education

- **User Experience Design Certificate**, Human Factors International, University of Stellenbosch, South Africa, 2007.
- **Graphic Design Diploma**, Ruth Prowse School of Art, Cape Town, South Africa, 1995.
- **Graphic Design Diploma**, Rudolf College of Art, Cape Town, South Africa, 1988.